

CUNY AI LAB

Configuring skills and tools

New Media Lab · Room 7388.01
CUNY Graduate Center

Thursday, October 15, 2026 · 2:30–4:00 p.m. Eastern

Developed by Zach Muhlbauer

https://cuny-ai-lab.github.io/sandbox-series/skills

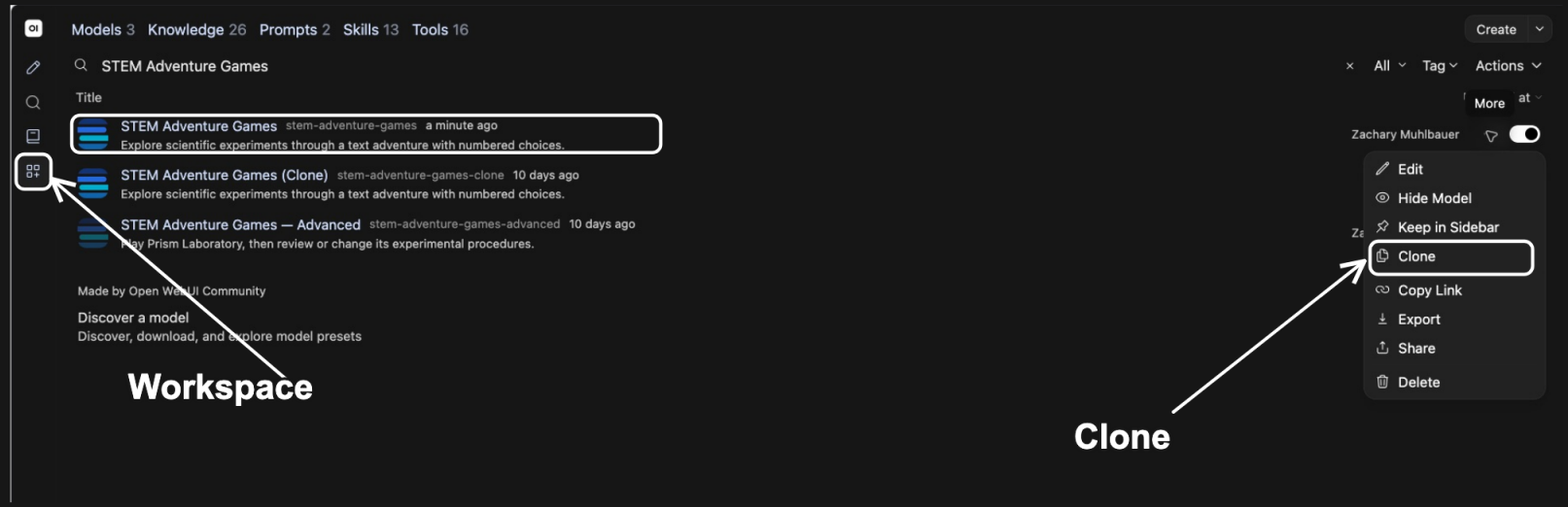
Choose Your Own Adventure

Continue your saved model or clone it first

Open **Workspace → Models → Edit**
Review your system prompt to identify setting, goals, and rules from last time

Keep this model card open while you add a skill and a tool

Select **Workspace** in left sidebar, then **Models**. Search for **STEM Adventure Games**. Open ••• beside it and select **Clone**.



What Is a Skill?

Skills contain plain-text instructions for repeatable tasks

Trigger	Request or condition that starts a procedure
Procedure	Steps, checks, and points that require a question
Output	Required response content and form

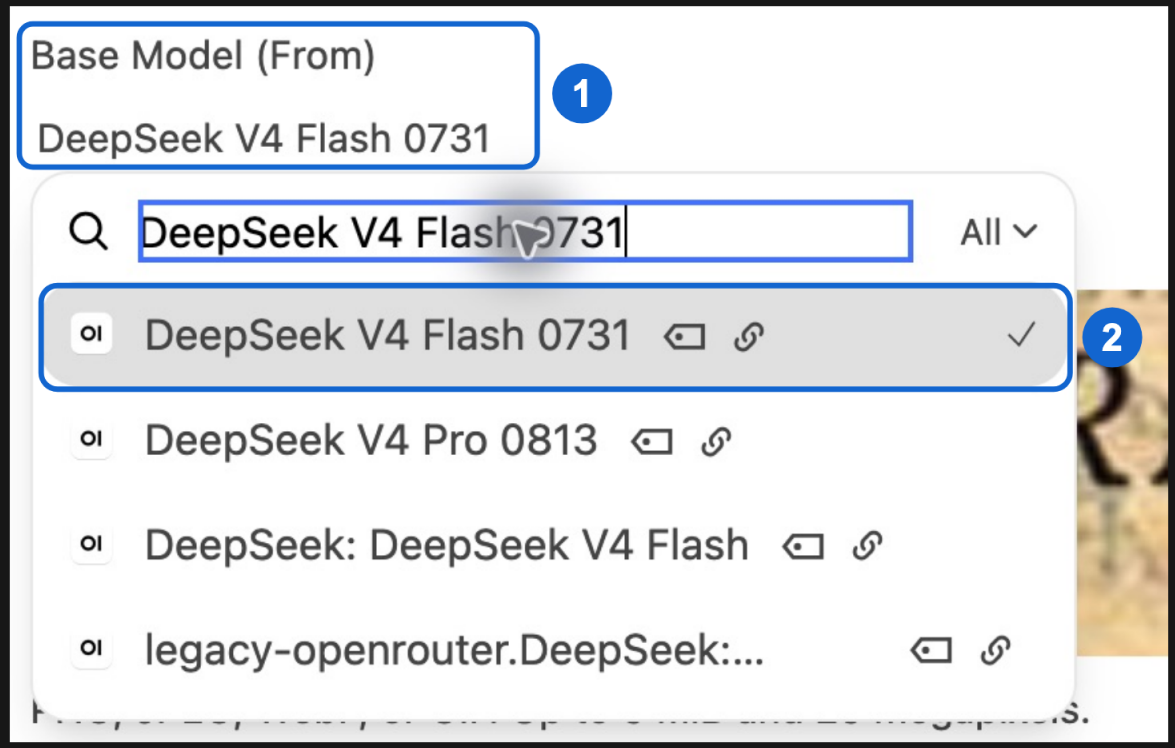
What Is a Tool?

When a model calls a **tool**, it is given the ability to execute a function and return its result, usually through a Python script

This is called **tool calling** (aka **function calling**)

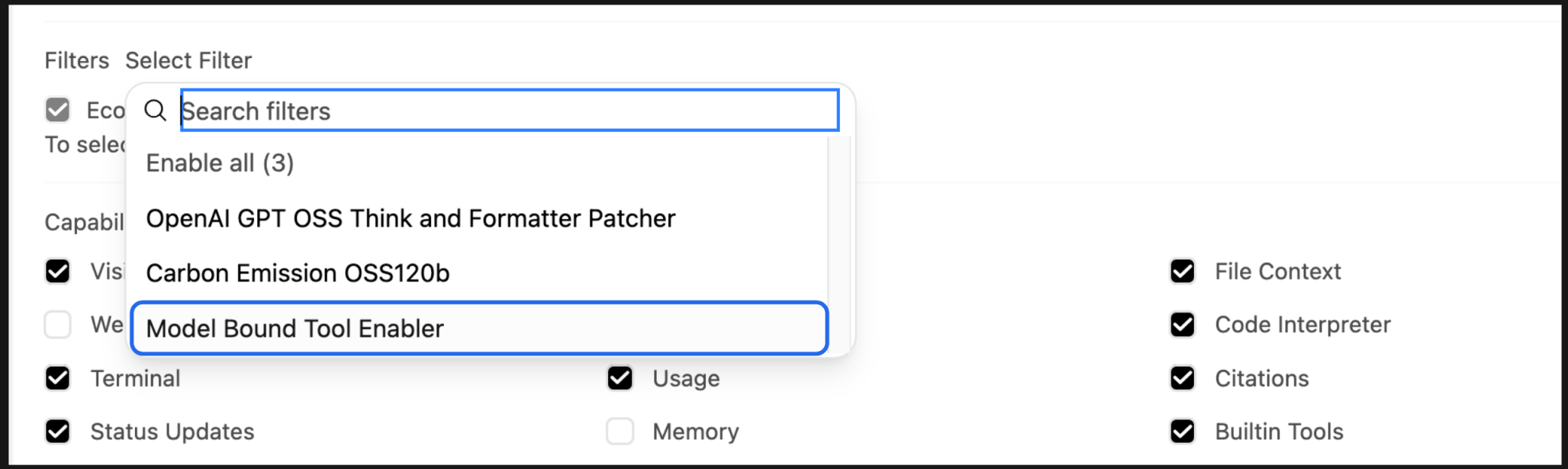
Input	Information passed to a function
Execution	Code that applies specified rules
Result	Returned output for a model to inspect

Update Model for Tool Calling



Enable Filter

Enable **Model Bound Tool Enabler** on your model card, which binds assigned tools to the model's operations.



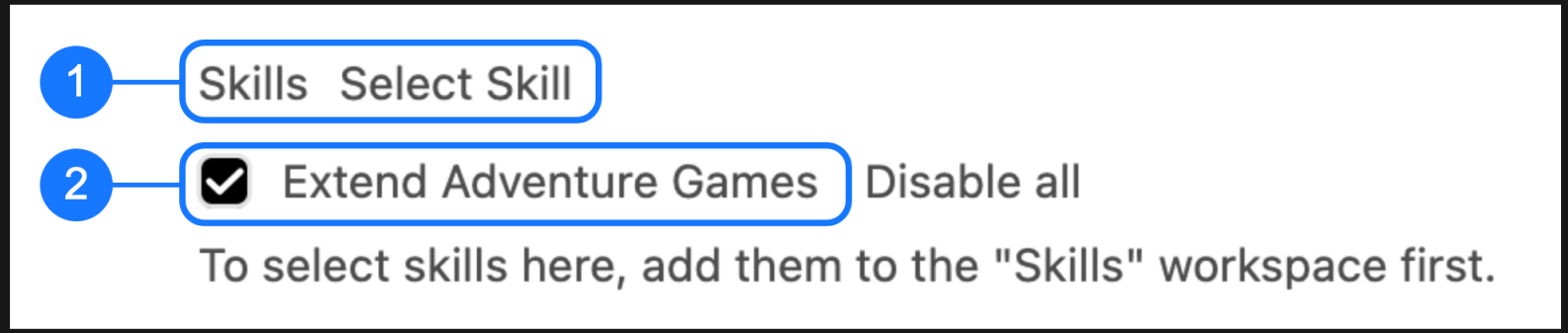
Add Your Skill

In **Workspace → Models → Edit**, find **Skills → Select Skill**

Choose existing **Extend Adventure Games**

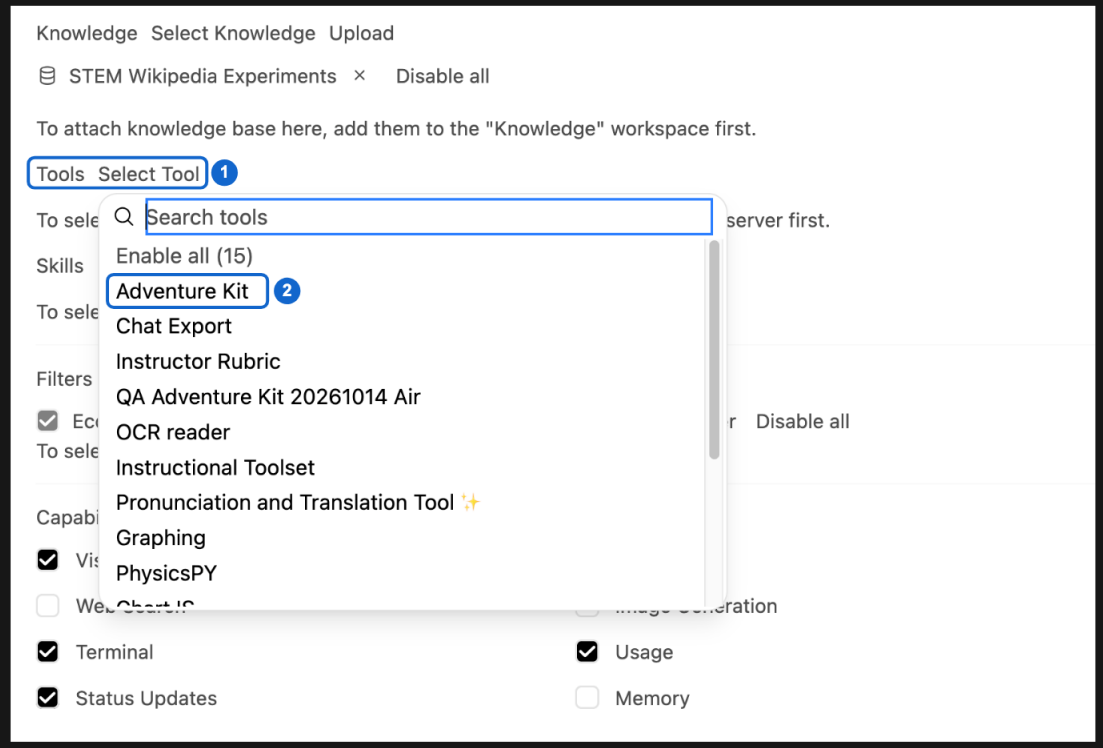
Read its saved instructions

Keep this model card open for Adventure Kit



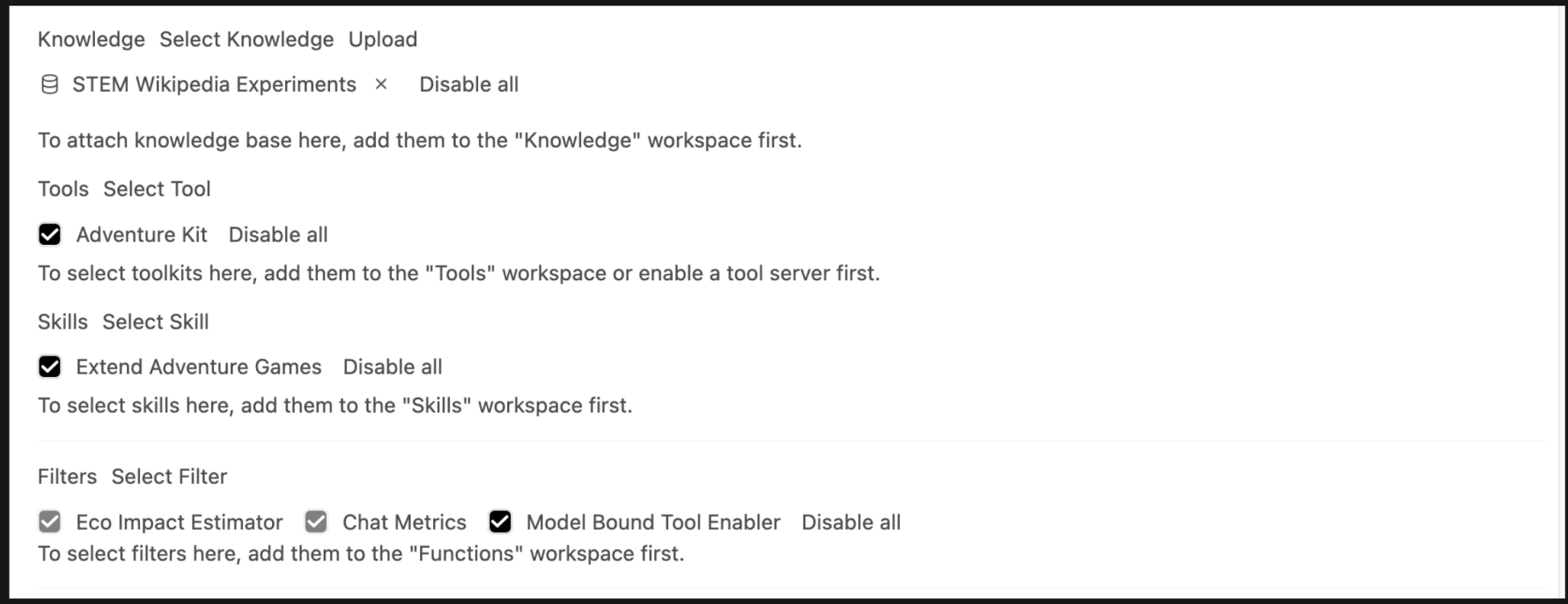
Add the ‘Adventure Kit’ tool

In this same model card, open **Tools → Select Tool**
Choose **Adventure Kit** · Confirm **Extend Adventure Games** remains selected
Add next prompt instruction, then click **Save & Update** before testing



Model Card Check-In

Ensure that your model card has a knowledge collection, tool, skill, and filter configured like the image below.



Add Skill Instructions to the Bottom of Your System Prompt

Copy prompt

```
Load the extend_adventure_games skill and follow it on every turn, calling the
adventure_kit tool only as the skill directs. Use no other skills or tools.
```

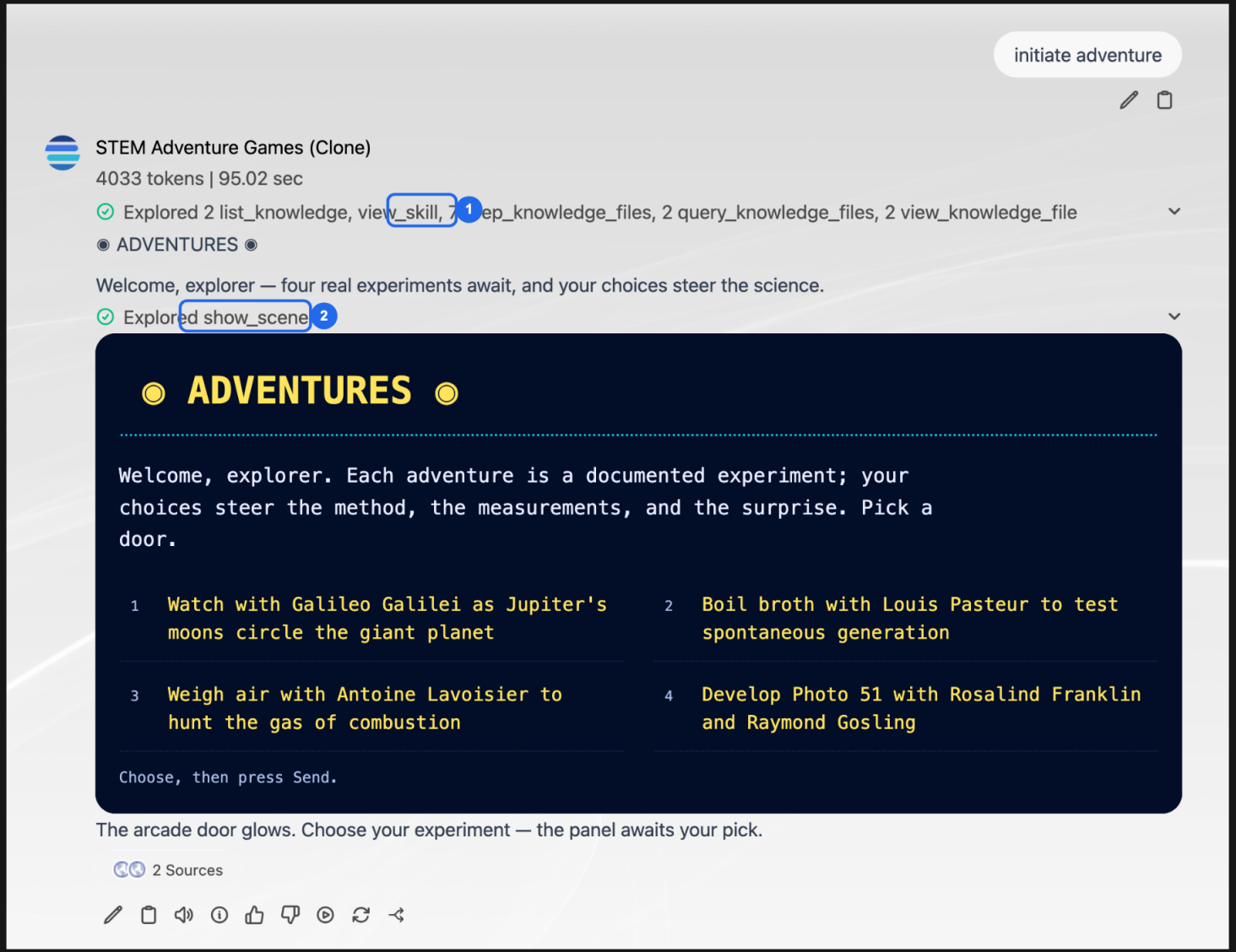
Test Your Adventure

1. Run your updated adventure game
2. Verify configured skill and tool are called appropriately
3. Then play the rest of your game

Observe Game Results

① Check skill call
② Check tool call

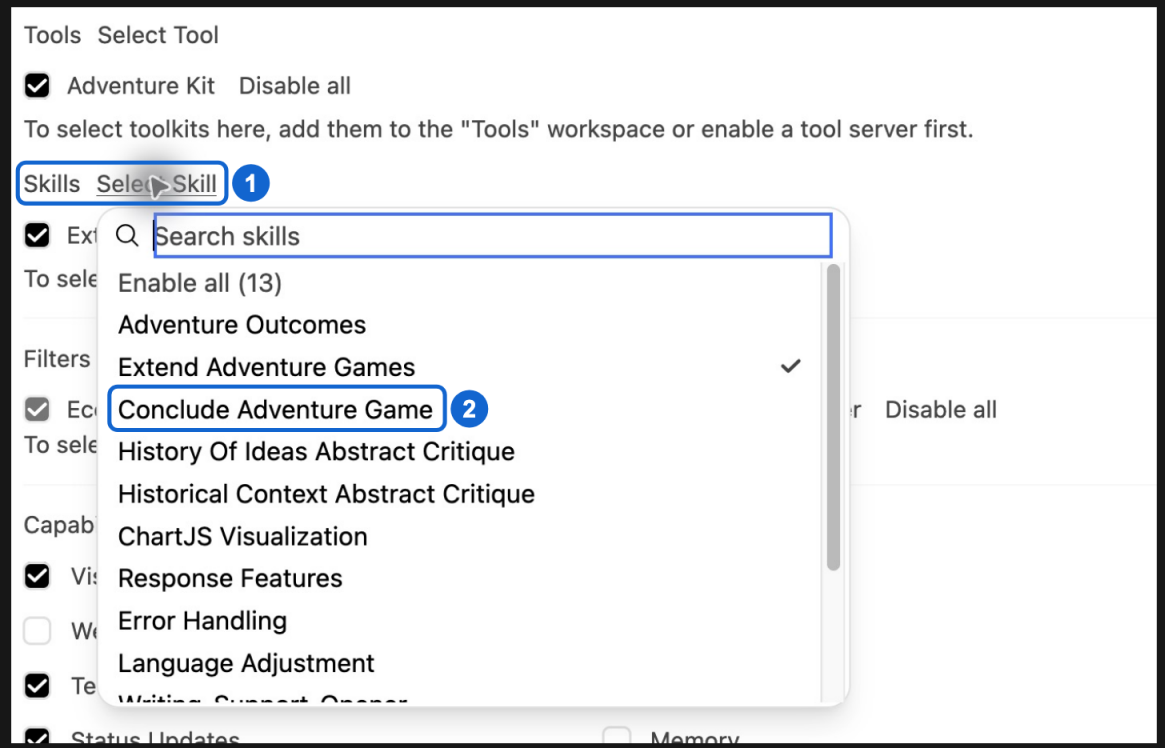
Open details to confirm selected skill



Explore Other Skills

After your first adventure works, try **Adventure Outcomes** or **Conclude Adventure Game**

Read saved instructions · Change one item · Save your model card and compare results



Choose Your Task

Revise One Item

Copy complete tool code or skill instructions

Describe an observed problem and one change

Copy tool code · Skill instructions

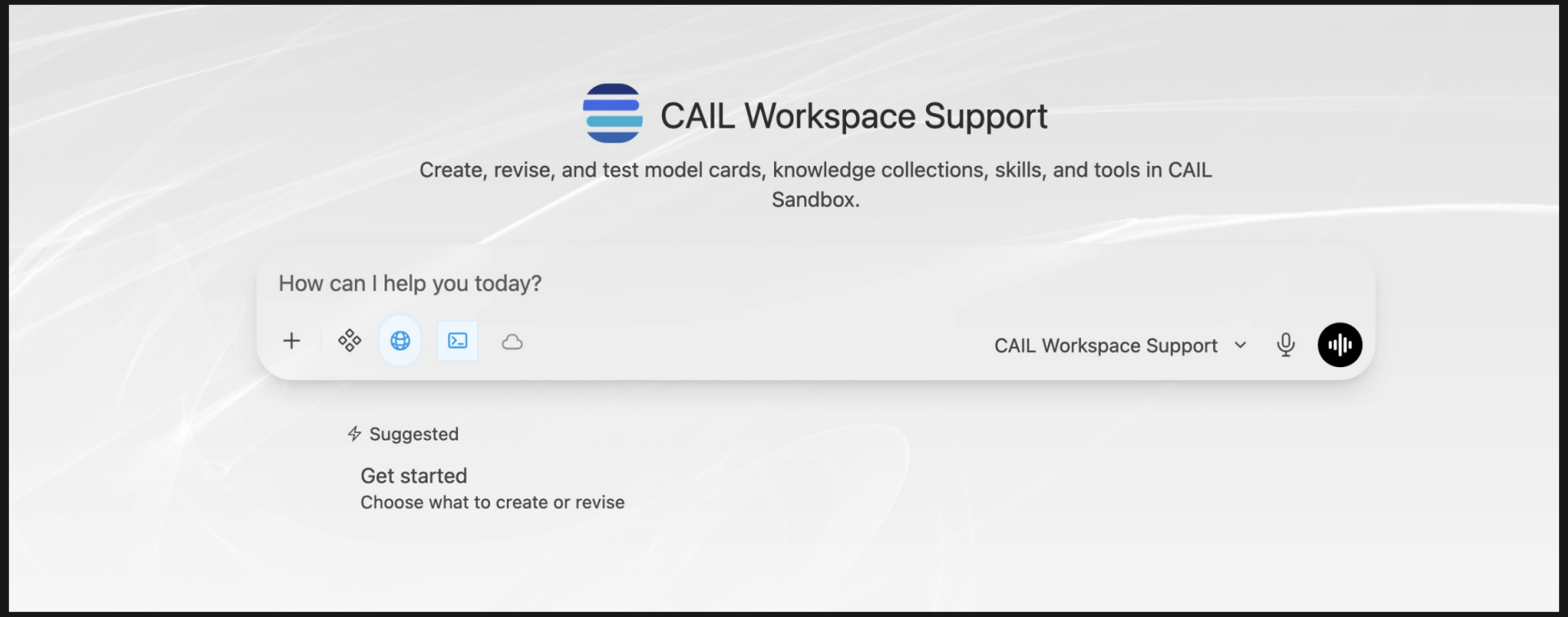
Create Your Own

Choose your own tool or skill

Specify purpose, required input, and expected result

Work With Support

Prompt CAIL Workspace Support to generate a skill and/or tool that continues to support or further extends your adventure game, adapting an existing skill/tool or making your own.



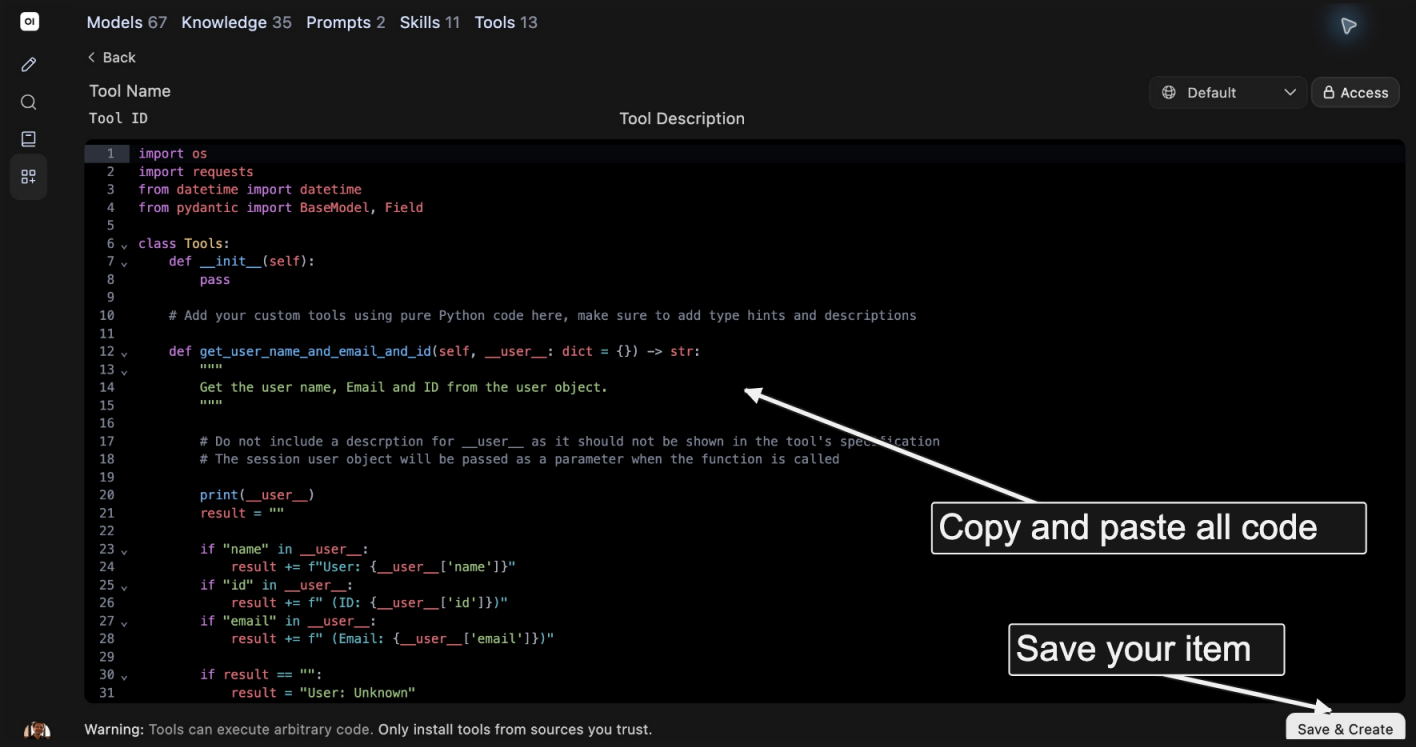
Adapt Your Adventure

Introduce a lesson plan, learning outcome, or disciplinary focus to your use of **CAIL Workspace Support** card

Prompted to generate a skill and/or tool that continues to support or further extends your adventure game, either adapting an existing skill or tool, or making your own.

Add Tools or Skills

Copy and paste all code for tools or plain text for skills, then save your item. On your model card, select your new tool or skill, and signpost it in your system prompt.



Series Reflections

What task in your teaching or research could benefit from a skill or tool?

Would you be interested in joining our coworking session on October 29, 2–4pm, to build your adventure into a collection so that we can showcase our work over the course of the series?

What would you develop next with the prompts, knowledge collections, skills, and tools you have explored?